

SELKIE

Eddies of lace, and stitches that swirl together smoothly combine to make this unique take on Tunisian crochet.

Difficulty: Intermediate

Handy Skills: Tunisian Crochet Basics, especially Tunisian re-sizing, decreasing and increasing

Recommended Hook Size:

5.5 hook (or size required to achieve tension)

Yarn: Green Elephant 100% SW Merino
(colourway: Petrol : 2-ply lace)
approx 500 m / 550 yards

Wingspan: 160 cm wide.

(This can be increased by adding multiples of 2 spirals during construction)

Tension: Using a 5.5 mm hook,

22 sts = 10 cm / 4 in

2 rows of L8tr & 2 rows sc = 10 cm / 4 in

Notions:

- darning needle for weaving in ends.
- at least 5, removable stitch markers.
- 1 x long blocking wire (approx 225 mm)
- 13 x short blocking wires (approx 50 cm each)
(see end of pattern for blocking wire alternatives)

Abbreviations:

ch	chain
sc	single crochet
YO	Yarn Over Hook
L8tr	Linked 8-uple treble
PM	Place (Stitch) Marker

DEC A 2-line decrease within a Linked st used to reduce the overall height of the stitch, eg. from a L4tr to a L3tr.

Lt dec a 2-stitch decrease that reduces the overall stitch number on the next row.

[] all sts written within []'s are worked in the same stitch space.
** all sts within ** are to be repeated, in sequence, the number of times indicated.

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If this is your first time working up a tunisian-lace shawl, I would suggest, before starting into the shawl, trying a little practise piece using smaller, linked 2-uple treble sts.

Instructions for working linked 2-uple treble stitches:

Make 11 chain, sc into 2nd ch from hook, and sc to end. This will give you a foundation to work your practise piece on.

Start the row of linked 2-uple trebles (L2tr):

Chain 3, work into the back loop of the 2nd chain from hook on the turning chain, insert hook, yo, pull through, repeat for 3rd chain from hook, insert hook into closest available stitch space, yo, pull through. You should have accumulated 4 loops on your hook. *yo, pull through 2 loops*, repeat until left with one loop (1st first stitch completed).

Second and every subsequent stitch:

The stitch will have two, parallel, horizontal lines up its length. Insert hook into closest horizontal line, yo and pull through. Repeat for other horizontal line. Insert hook into closest available stitch space, yo, pull through. Work the four loops now on your hook as for the first stitch.

Notes on working larger linked stitches:
Work similarly to a linked-2-uple treble (explained above), but begin with the number of chains specified in the pattern. This will give more “yo and pull through”s, and will result in a taller stitch, with more horizontal lines up its length.

Chart Reading Video Help:

www.youtube.com/watch?v=tMvwxd-7do

Variable Height Ltr sts Video Help:

www.youtube.com/watch?v=OUb7Kzinri8

Foundationless Linked Rows Video Help:

www.youtube.com/watch?v=1ckTIGfD9Fg

This pattern contains several less-common crochet techniques, occasionally in quick succession.

It is advisable to work with two colours on a practise spiral before beginning the shawl itself so that you become familiar with the techniques required.

It should be necessary to work this practise piece only as far as STRAND C or so.

# of Horizontal Lines	Chains at Beginning of Row (1st ch is left unused)	Stitch Name	Abbreviation
1	2	Linked 1-uple treble	L1tr
2	3	Linked 2-uple treble	L2tr
3	4	Linked 3-uple treble	L3tr
4	5	Linked 4-uple treble	L4tr
5	6	Linked 5-uple treble	L5tr
etc...			



PATTERN BEGINS

Foundation Spiral: With STRAND A, into a Magic Loop, make 8 sc. Do Not Join.



Stitch Space 1. 1 sc
Stitch Space 2. [2 sc], YO,



Stitch Space 3. [2 L1tr], YO,



Stitch Space 4. [2 L2tr]

Set STRAND A aside. Secure loop with a stitch marker.



With STRAND B,
Hook into Stitch Space 4, YO with STRAND B and draw loop through st. This loop will be very loose, but don't worry, we'll secure it in the next stitch.

Stitch Space 5. Using both tail and ball end of STRAND B, make 1 sc.
PM1 in this sc st



Stitch Space 6. [2 sc], YO,

Stitch Space 7. [2 L1tr], YO,

Stitch Space 8. [2 L2tr],



Total Stitch Count
(i.e. all stitches on outer edge): 14.

Round 2.

Set STRAND B aside. Secure loop with a stitch marker.

With STRAND A,
Stitch Space 1. YO, [2 L3tr] into M1 st, YO.
 Remove Marker 1.



Stitch Space 2. [2 L4tr], YO,

Stitch Space 3. [2 L5tr], YO

Stitch Space 4. [2 L6tr]

Total Stitch Count: 18.



With STRAND B,
Stitch Space 5. YO, [2 L3tr], YO,

Stitch Space 6. [2 L4tr], YO,

Stitch Space 7. [2 L5tr], YO,
Stitch Space 8. [2 L6tr]

Total Stitch Count: 22



Round 3.
 Set STRAND B aside.
 Secure loop with a stitch marker.

With STRAND A work the following sequence:

Stitch Space 1. [2 L6tr],

Stitch Space 2. [Decrease into first two lines of previous st (hereafter abbreviated to DEC) and make 2 L5tr],



[DEC, and make 2 L4tr],
 [DEC, and make 2 L3tr],
 [DEC, and make 2 L2tr],
 [DEC, and make 2 L1tr],



[2 sc], 1 sc, 1 ss,

Bind off STRAND A.

Total Stitch Count of STRAND A: 26 (excl the ss)



With STRAND B
Stitch Space 1. [2 L6tr]

HERE'S HOW TO WORK BASIC FOUNDATION STITCHES THROUGHOUT THIS PATTERN.

Note: If you are familiar with Traditionally-made Tunisian, the term “Foundation Ltr” here refers to a row of traditionally-made TSS. The number of TSS sts in the row is signified by the number included in the name. ie. Foundation L5tr = 5 TSS

1st Foundation Stitch.

Downward pass:

Work as normal. Work into base of next available st, YO and pull up a loop.

Upward pass:

YO, pull through ONE loop. (This will make a chain stitch at the base of your stitch. Put a Marker in it, if you think you'll lose sight of it),
Then *YO & pull through two loops* until back to one loop on hook.

2nd and every subsequent Foundation Stitch.

Downward pass:

Work as normal, then work hook into chain st Marked at base of previous st, then, YO and pull up a loop.

Upward Pass:

Work Upward Pass as with 1st Foundation St.

**All subsequent stitches are to be worked as
FOUNDATION STITCHES.**

Stitch Space 2.

1 L6tr, leave off final “YO & pull through” of upward pass.
You should have two loops left on hook.



Now, work 1 L6tr as follows:

With 2 loops already on hook from previous st, work the downward pass as usual into remaining 5 lines.

Work into previous stitch's base chain, YO and pull up a loop.



Now, work upward pass as for a Foundation L6tr as follows:

YO, through 1 (creates base chain for NEXT st), *YO through 2* to end.

Note: These two sts combined make one “Ltr decrease” (hereafter abbreviated to Ltr dec) - ie. 2 legs that share a single head. These “Lt dec” sts will be a feature of every spiral in this shawl.



ref: Two sts, sharing one “head” or “v” at the top.

We also have to reduce the *height* of the sts themselves too, gradually working the height from L6tr down to L1tr.

This is how we'll accomplish that:

Pick up loops in all available lines, except the last two.

DEC using final two lines.



Work into base chain of previous st, and then complete all of upward pass (except last “YO & pull through”)



Complete Ltr dec’s second leg thus:

With 2 loops already on hook from previous st, work the downward pass as usual into remaining 4 lines.

Work into previous stitch’s base chain, and work upward pass as for a Foundation L6tr as follows:

YO, through 1 (creates base chain for NEXT st), *YO through 2* to end.



In summary, we have completed the following techniques:

You started with an L6tr dec (which has two bases but one head).

Then, you used a DEC at the bottom of the first leg of the next Ltr dec to reduce the number of lines from 6 to 5 (making it an L5tr dec).

We will repeat this set of actions until we're down to L2trs thus:

1. Make an L5tr dec.



2. Set up and make next L4tr dec thus,

Leg 1:

Downward Pass:

Pick up loops using all but last two horizontal lines.

DEC into last two horizontal lines.

Hook into chain at base of previous st, YO and pull through.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 1 loop.

YO and pull through 2 loops until 2 loops are left on hook.

Leg 2.

Downward Pass:

With 2 loops already on hook, pick up loops in all remaining horizontal lines.

Hook into chain at base of previous st, YO and draw up a loop.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 1 loop.

YO and pull through two loops until one loop is left on hook.



3. Make a second L4tr dec.

4. Set up and make next L3tr dec thus,

Leg 1:**Downward Pass:**

Pick up loops using all but last two horizontal lines.
 DEC into last two horizontal lines.
 Hook into chain at base of previous st, YO and pull through.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 1 loop.
 YO and pull through 2 loops until 2 loops are left on hook.

Leg 2.**Downward Pass:**

With 2 loops already on hook, pick up loops in all remaining horizontal lines.
 Hook into chain at base of previous st, YO and draw up a loop.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 1 loop.
 YO and pull through two loops until one loop is left on hook.

5. Make a second L3tr dec.

6. Set up and make next L2tr dec thus,

Leg 1:**Downward Pass:**

Pick up loops using all but last two horizontal lines.
 DEC into last two horizontal lines.
 Hook into chain at base of previous st, YO and pull through.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 1 loop.
 YO and pull through 2 loops until 2 loops are left on hook.

Leg 2.**Downward Pass:**

With 2 loops already on hook, pick up loops in all remaining horizontal lines.
 Hook into chain at base of previous st, YO and draw up a loop.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 1 loop.
 YO and pull through two loops until one loop is left on hook.

7. Make a second L2tr dec.



Finish using following sequence:

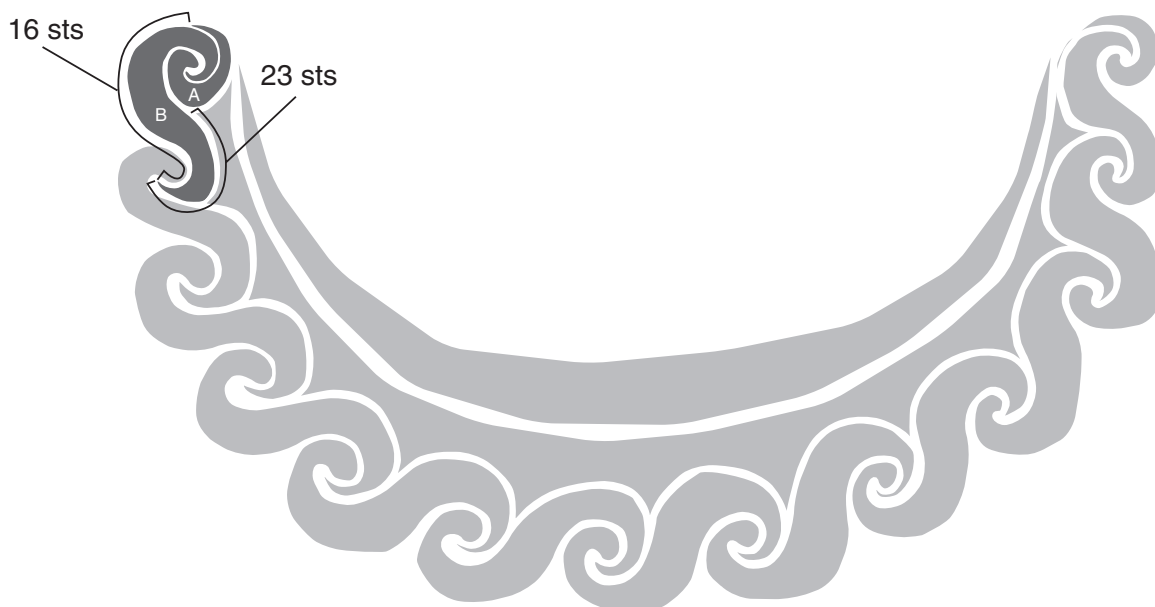
- Make a DEC using 2 remaining lines.
- Hook into base ch of previous st, YO & pull through 1 loop - 3 loops on hook.
- YO, through 1 (base chain made), YO & pull through 2 - 2 loops on hook.
- Hook into base chain, YO & pull through 1 loop
- YO & pull through 1 loop (base chain made), *YO & pull through 2* twice - 1 loop on hook
- Hook into 1 remaining line, YO & pull through - 2 loops on hook
- Hook into base, YO & pull through - 3 loops on hook
- YO & pull through 1 (base chain made), YO & pull through 2 - 2 loops on hook
- Hook into base chain, YO & pull through 1 loop
- YO & pull through 1 loop (base chain made), *YO & pull through 2* twice - 1 loop on hook

1 sc into base chain to finish.

Bind off and cut yarn.

STRAND B HEAD Stitch Count: 16 (counting tops of sts, from after ss)

STRAND B BASE Stitch Count: 23 (counting base of sts, starting with the side of the last sc made)



PM1 in TOP of sc st

PM2 in SIDE of sc st

Note: Yes, these two markers technically go into the same hole.

Be sure to place one on either side of the bind off point.

PM3 in BASE CHAIN sc was worked into.

Note: These markers are very important as they will ensure your stitch count stays accurate on the next spiral.

With STRAND C,
into a Magic Loop, make 8 sc.
Do Not Join.



Stitch Space 1.

1 sc, then work hook from WS to RS of fabric and make 1 ss into M1
(remove marker)



Stitch Space 2.

1 sc, 1 ss into next st of STRAND B,
 1 sc into same st as last sc,
 1 ss into next st to the left along STRAND B, YO.

**Stitch Space 3.**

1 L1tr into next st of STRAND C,
 1 ss into next st of STRAND B,
 1 L1tr into same st as last L1tr,
 1 ss into next st to the left along STRAND B.



Stitch Space 4.

1 L1tr into next st of STRAND C,
 1 ss into next st of STRAND B,
 1 L1tr into same st as last L1tr,
 1 ss into next st to the left along STRAND B, YO.

**Stitch Space 5.**

1 L2tr into next st of STRAND C,
 1 ss into next st of STRAND B,
 1 L2tr into same st as last L2tr,
 1 ss into next st to the left along STRAND B.



Stitch Space 6.

1 L2tr into next st of STRAND C,
 1 ss into next st of STRAND B,
 1 L2tr into same st as last L2tr,
 1 ss into next st to the left along STRAND B, YO.

**Stitch Space 7.**

1 L3tr into next st of STRAND C,
 1 ss into next st of STRAND B
 1 L3tr into same st as last L3tr,
 1 ss into next st to the left along STRAND B
 (the st to ss into on Strand B will be a bit tighter than the previous ones).

Stitch Space 8: [2 L3tr], YO.

Into 1st sc of round: [2 L4tr].

Into st marked by M2: [2 L4tr], YO.

Into st marked by M3: [2 L5tr].

Into next base st: [2 L5tr], YO.

Into next base st: [2 L6tr].

Into next base st: [2 L6tr], YO.

Into next base st: [2 L7tr].

Into next base st: [2 L7tr], YO.

Into next base st: [2 L8tr].

Into next base st: [2 L8tr]

STRAND C Stitch Count: 22

(counting back over sts just worked, up to join with previous strand)

**All subsequent stitches are to be worked as
FOUNDATION STITCHES.**

1. Make an L8tr dec.

2. Set up and make next L7tr dec thus,

Leg 1:

Downward Pass:

Pick up loops using all but last two horizontal lines.

DEC into last two horizontal lines.

Hook into chain at base of previous st, YO and pull through.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 1 loop.

YO and pull through 2 loops until 2 loops are left on hook.

Leg 2.

Downward Pass:

With 2 loops already on hook, pick up loops in all remaining horizontal lines.

Hook into chain at base of previous st, YO and draw up a loop.

Upward Pass:

YO and pull through 1 loop.

YO and pull through two loops until one loop is left on hook.

3. Make a second L7tr dec.

Repeat pattern as established in steps 2 and 3 until L2tr sequence is complete.

Finish using following sequence:

- Make a DEC using 2 remaining lines.
- Hook into base ch of previous st, YO & pull through 1 loop - 3 loops on hook.
- YO, through 1 (base chain made), YO & pull through 2 - 2 loops on hook.
- Hook into base chain, YO & pull through 1
- YO & pull through 1 (base chain made), *YO & pull through 2* twice - 1 loop on hook
- Hook into 1 remaining line, YO & pull through - 2 loops on hook
- Hook into base, YO & pull through - 3 loops on hook
- YO & pull through 1 (base chain made), YO & pull through 2 - 2 loops on hook
- Hook into base chain, YO & pull through 1
- YO & pull through 1 (base chain made), *YO & pull through 2* twice - 1 loop on hook
- 1 sc into base chain to finish.
- Bind off and cut yarn.

PM1 in TOP of sc st

PM2 in SIDE of sc st

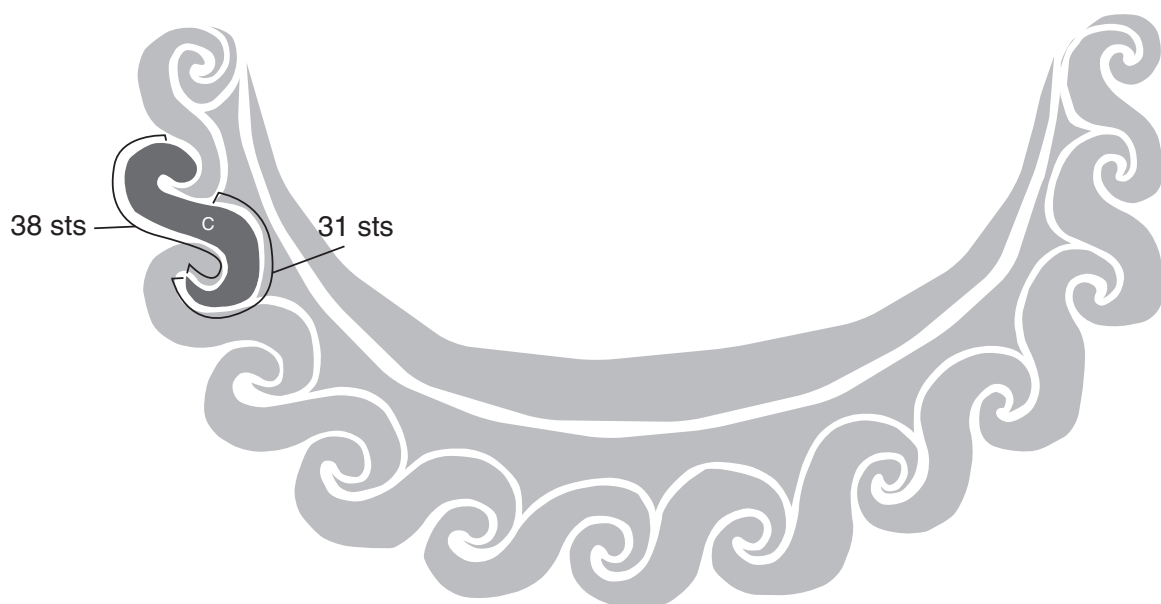
*Note: Yes, these two markers technically go into the same hole.
Be sure to place one on either side of the bind off point.*

PM3 in BASE CHAIN sc was worked into.

Bind off and cut yarn.

STRAND C HEAD Stitch Count: 38 (counting tops of sts, from after ss)

STRAND C BASE Stitch Count: 31 (counting back over sts just worked,
up to join with previous strand)



STRAND D.

Repeat as for STRAND C, but continue ss connections up to completion of L4tr sequence, and continue increasing height of Ltr sts up to L10tr before beginning the decrease section.

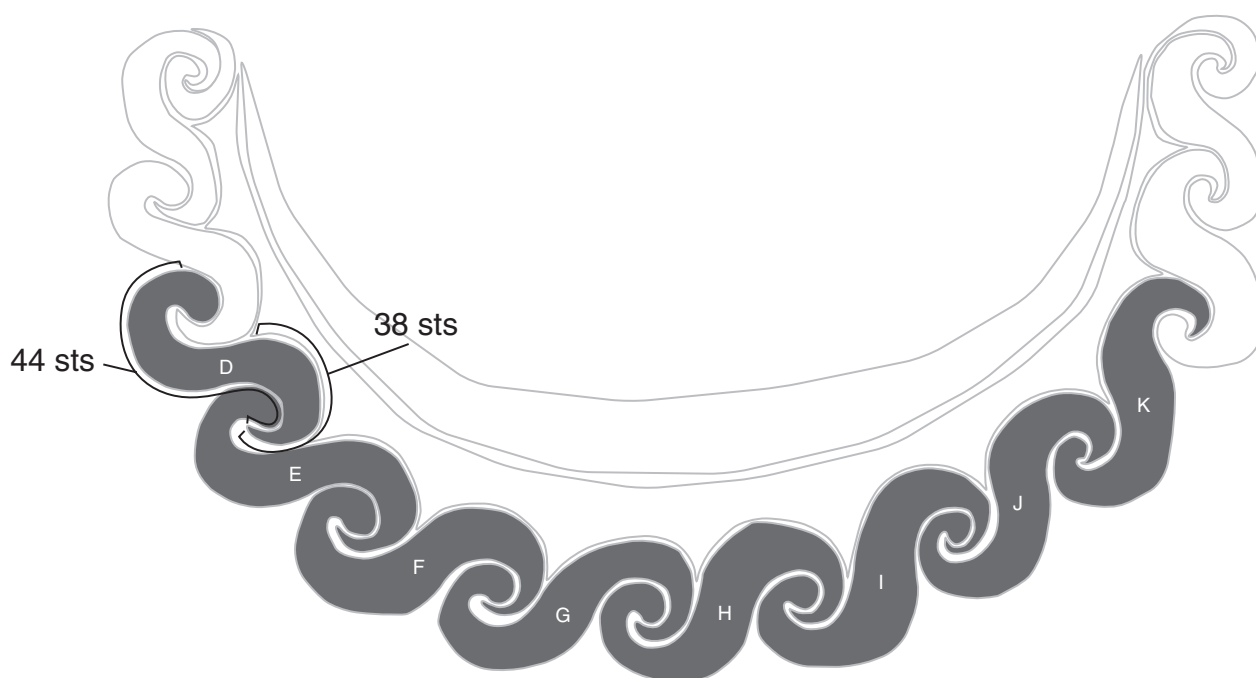
Bind off and cut yarn.

With STRANDS E - K.

As with STRAND D.

STRAND D - K HEAD Stitch Count: 44 (counting tops of sts, from after ss)

STRAND D - K BASE Stitch Count: 38 (counting back over sts just worked, up to join with previous strand)



Note: Strands L - N take on a slightly different stitch sequence in order to ensure the stitch counts on the *next* Ltr row stay even. The gap between spirals will seem a little wider than before, but this is nothing to worry about as long as your stitch counts on HEAD and BASE of strands is correct (or at least... very very close).

You may also notice that the gentle curve upwards of previous spirals is way more pronounced. This, again, is a consequence of keeping the stitch count on the next Ltr row even. Your finished shawl won't be mis-shapen as a result of this increase in curve.

STRAND L:

Into a Magic Loop, work 5 sc.

Work ss connections up to end of L4tr sequence.

Then,
 YO, *[2 L5tr]* 4 times, YO,
 [2 L6tr] 4 times, YO,
 [2 L7tr] 4 times, YO,
 [2 L8tr] 4 times,

Then, start into Foundation sts and DEC's as previously established
 (refer to Page 20 for how to do this, if you need a refresher).

STRAND L HEAD Stitch Count: 49 (counting tops of sts, from after ss)
 STRAND L BASE Stitch Count: 30 (counting back over sts just worked,
 up to join with previous strand)

**STRAND M:**

Into a Magic Loop, work 5 sc.

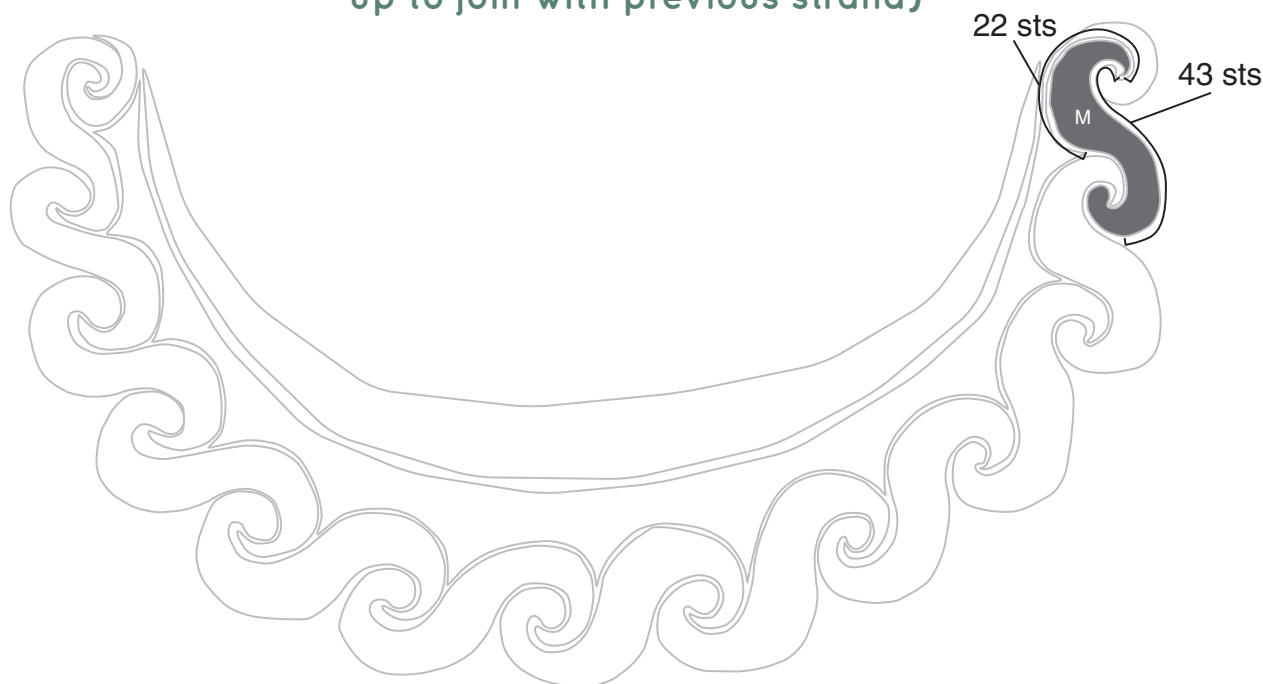
Work ss connections up to end of L3tr sequence.

YO, *[2 L4tr]* 4 times, YO
 [2 L5tr] 5 times, YO,
 [2 L6tr] 6 times

Then, start into Foundation sts and DEC's as previously established.

STRAND M HEAD Stitch Count: 43 (counting tops of sts, from after ss)

STRAND M BASE Stitch Count: 22 (counting back over sts just worked, up to join with previous strand)



STRAND N:

Into a Magic Loop, work 5 sc.

Work ss connections up to end of L2tr sequence.

Then,

YO, *[2 L3tr]* twice, YO,

[2 L4tr] twice, YO,

[2 L5tr] twice,

Work the following sequence:

DEC, and make *[2 L4tr]* twice,

DEC, and make *[2 L3tr]* twice,

DEC, and make *[2 L2tr]* twice,

DEC, and make *[2 L1tr]* twice,

1 sc.

Do not bind off.

STRAND N Stitch Count: 30

(counting back over sts just worked, up to join with previous strand)

When finished, you should have 13 double spirals complete.

BODY:**Row 1.**

1 sc into the next st.

PM in sc just made.

Work a further 9 sc evenly along downward curve of last spiral made, halting at bottom of valley.

Work 15 sc evenly along upward and downward curve of next spiral, halting at bottom of valley.

Work 21 sc evenly along upward and downward curve of next spiral, halting at bottom of valley.

Work 28 sc evenly along upward and downward curves, of next spiral, halting at bottom of valley. repeat seven times, then,

Work 21 sc evenly along upward and downward curves, of next spiral, halting at bottom of valley.

Work 15 sc evenly along upward and downward curves, of next spiral, halting at bottom of valley.

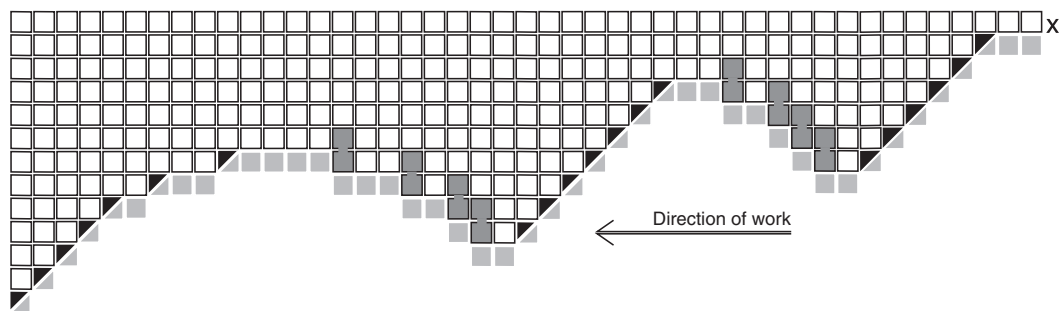
Work 10dc evenly along upward curve of first spiral, halting at top of curve, 1 ss, turn.

Body Stitch Count, counting from Marked sc at beginning of row: 288 sts (turning ss does not count as a st)

Row 2. sc in each st to Marker, 1 sc into Marked st, remove Marker, 1 ss into next st, turn - 288 sts (turning ss does not count as a st)



Chart A



Key:

- Regular Space
- Yarn Over (Tunisian Eyelet)
- Tunisian Decrease (2 lines together)
- "yo & pull through" into base
- X UK dc / US sc
- ss (slip stitch)

Chart B

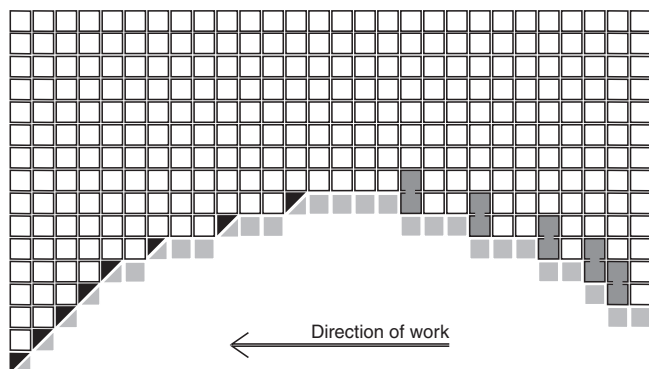


Chart C

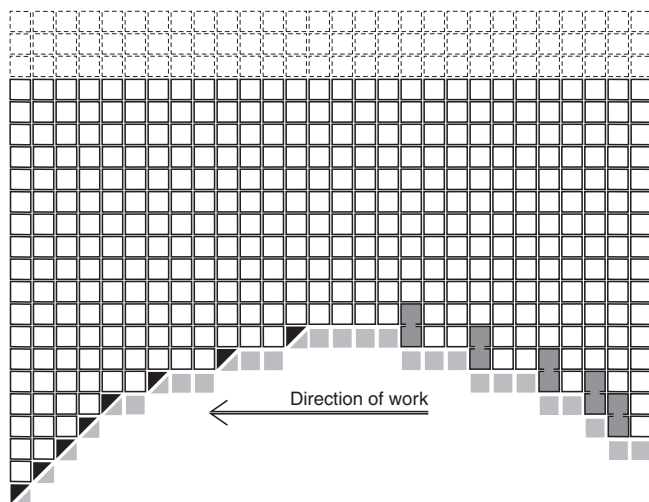
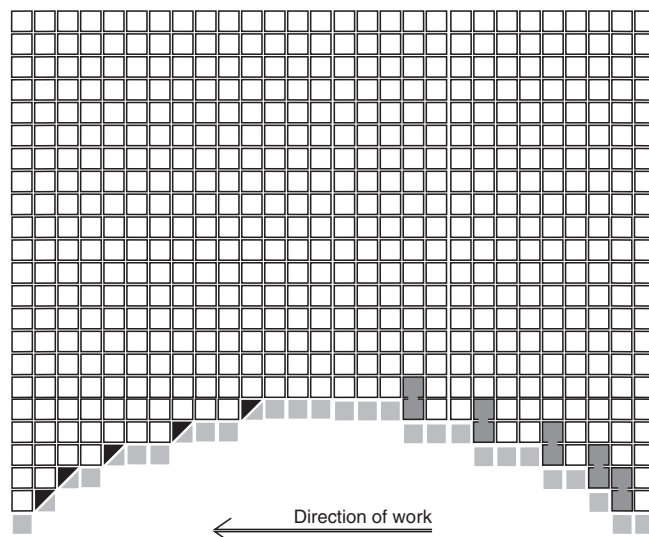


Chart D



Row 3. 1 ch, work Chart A once, Chart B once, work Chart C twice baring in mind that the height of the second repeat will *increase* by three spaces, work Chart D once, then work Chart E twice baring in mind that the height of the second repeat will *decrease* by three spaces, work Chart F once and then Chart G once, ending on the charted slip stitch, turn.

Row 4. 288 sc, 1 sc into same space as turning ss.
Into next space, make 1 turning ss, turn.
- 289 sts

Row 5.
6 sc, YO, 6 L1tr,
YO at base of next st to make it a L2tr,
5 L2tr,
YO at base of next st to make it a L3tr,
5 L3tr,
YO at base of next st to make it a L4tr,
5 L4tr,
Continue sequence as established until L17trs are complete.
Then, make 80 L17tr,
DEC at the base of next st to make it a L16tr, 5 L16tr.
DEC at the base of next st to make it a L15tr, 5 L15tr.
DEC at the base of next st to make it a L14tr, 5 L14tr.

Continue sequence as established until dcs at end of sequence are complete. Final sc should be worked into turning ss of previous row.

- 290 sts

1 ss into next st, 291 sc, 1 ss, Bind off.

FINISHING:

Block gently using bending blocking wires (see diagramme at bottom of this page for a guide),

Or, in a pinch, use any thin plastic cable that can be manipulated into shape to help preserve Selkie's smooth curves.

Note: weed-whacker cable/trimmer cord is perfect for this job, plus, it's cheap! The cord I used to block Selkie was 1.6 mm / 6/100th of an inch thick, but you can go a little thicker or thinner if you can't get that exact measurement.

Circular knitting needle cables are also handy in a pinch, but you'll need one for each curve, so, if you don't have enough yourself, make friends with a bunch of knitters!

Chart E

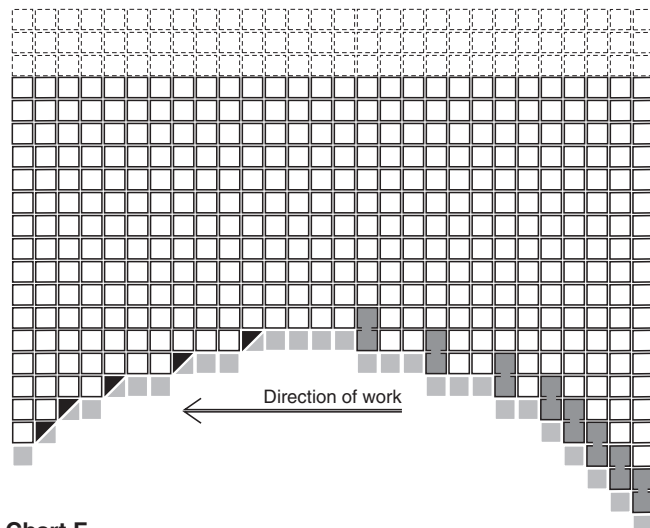


Chart F

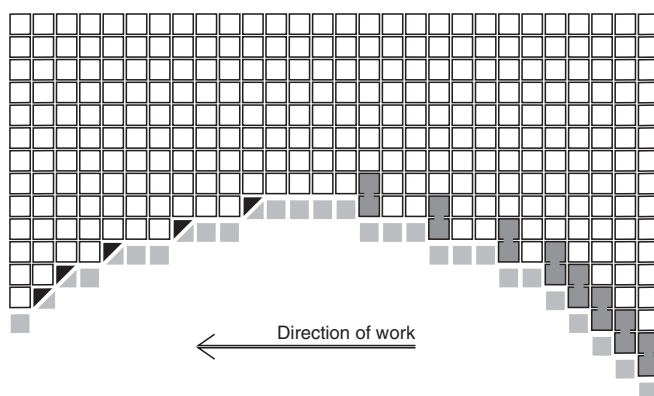
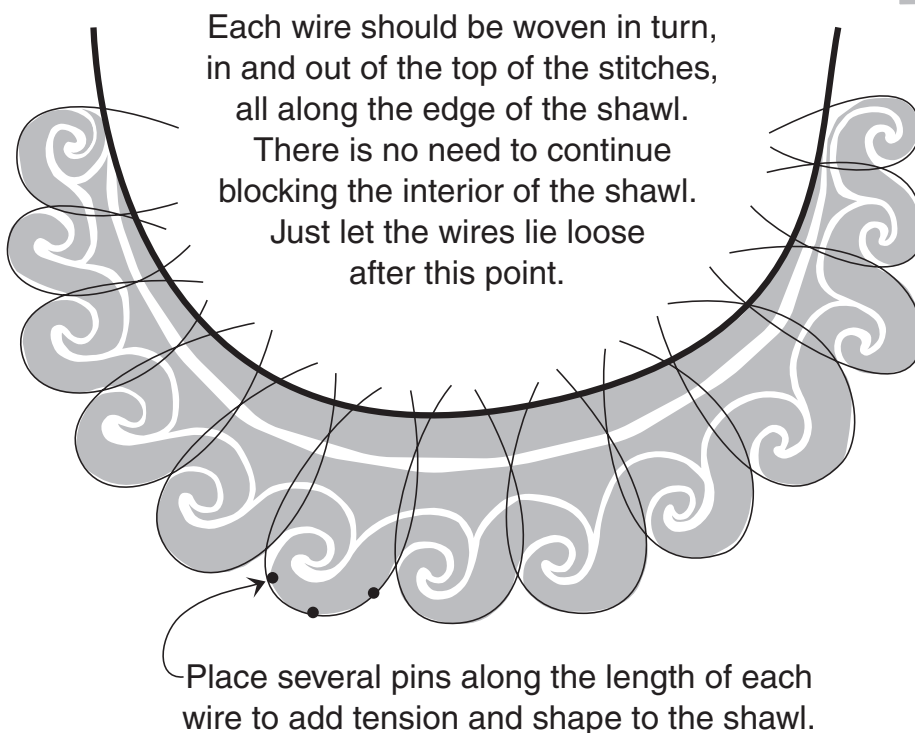
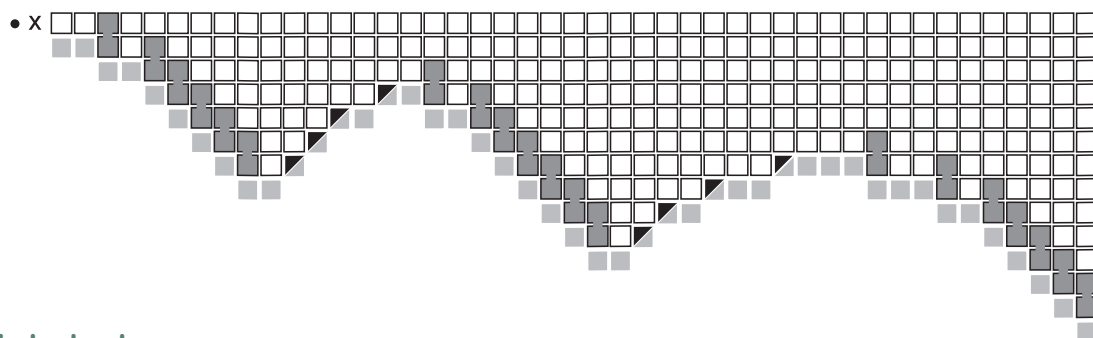


Chart G



A note of thanks to...

This Wall is dedicated to the marvelous people who have pledged their support at the "All The Things!" tier on my Patreon Page while this shawl was being designed.

(www.patreon.com/aoibheni)

Without their generosity and moral support, I'd not be able to keep designing full time.

This is my way of giving a little back to them because they deserve recognition!

